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2. Metadata should be electronically-signed, for example, with an elliptic curve signature that relies on a private key issued by the update root certification authority used by the device vendor.

3. Signature should be verified using the corresponding public key stored securely on the device, ideally using hardware-based security storage features. If this verification fails, the update process is aborted.

Secure software update images can also be kept confidential. When these are transferred over public networks, confidentiality prevents reverse-engineering and protects against IP theft. To enable confidentiality, the device must know the decryption key. This can be done, for example, by deriving the update key from an update master key assigned to the device during manufacturing, and combining this with metadata. The key is derived by cryptographically combining a secret key with further device-specific information. This enables a higher security level than can be achieved by using the same secure software image decryption key over the device's entire lifecycle.

Challenges of software-only security. Unfortunately, software has several inherent and significant weaknesses. It is written code that can be read and analysed. Once it has been analysed, it can be modified to the requirements of an attacker. Authentication process and system integrity can be broken, if a device is reprogrammed with modified software.

Inappropriate storage of secret keys during various processes and production steps is another potential weakness of software-based solutions. Attackers can easily identify secret keys in software-based protection systems, which are built into the software or otherwise stored in readable form.

Complete security design combines hardware with software

Software can be protected by hardware. Secure hardware detects faults and manipulation, and protects processing and storage of code using encryption, secure code and data storage. Software, thus, becomes trustworthy when combined with secure hardware.

There is one crucial difference between security and other features. With regular features, the update process only has to make sure that functionality has been correctly implemented. With security features, however, algorithms must be correctly implemented and secured against attacks. This is set to become an increasingly challenging task for many device manufacturers, as attack models are becoming more sophisticated.

Hardware-based security offers strong, tamper-proof protection for connected devices. Software, code and data are stored and processed in secure areas. Encrypted memory and processing, fault and manipulation detection as well as secure code and data storage combined enable a high level of protection. **EFY**